COUNTRY REPORTS: SOMALIA

NEWS · MATURITY · FINANCE · ONLINE HOSTING

Status report

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Somalia's governing ICT policy has expired and its successor is not adopted. The National ICT Policy and Strategy 2019-2024 set the country's positions on broadband, cybersecurity, data centres and cloud services, data protection and digital payments; the Digital Transformation Strategy for 2025-2030 was validated at a national multi-stakeholder workshop in October 2025 with ITU support and was still being finalised, intended to coordinate every national digital initiative, interoperability included, with no separate data exchange strategy beside it. It is drawn as a single national framework covering education, health, agriculture and finance.

What the ministries have published in the interval is narrower. The Ministry of Communications and Technology issued an eGovernment Strategy for 2025-2029 in August 2025, carrying the plan for domestic government hosting and digital service delivery. The Council of Ministers approved an Inclusive Digital Policy in January 2025, and a National Data Policy Framework covering how data is collected, shared, classified and retained, and its sovereignty, was validated in March 2026.

Delivery is clearest where it has a named owner. Trade facilitation is coordinated by Sadaq Mohamed, National Trade Facilitation Coordinator in the Office of the Prime Minister, and the National Trade Facilitation Committee concluded a two-day strategic induction and roadmap workshop in Mogadishu on 3 August 2026, with nineteen priority legal and policy instruments — rules of origin, competition and consumer protection, special economic zones, intellectual property — mapped and scheduled to run alongside the trade-facilitation digital systems (August 2026). Against that, no timetable, budget or vendor has been stated for any of those systems.

The governing capacity these plans sit on is weak and slowly improving. Somalia scores 25.5 out of 100 for overall governance in 2023, 53rd of 54 African states, after a ten-year gain of 6.8 points, and sits below the continental average on all sixteen sub-categories, in the bottom ten on thirteen of them, and above the African average on only six of the index's 96 indicators, on a GDP per capita of USD 643.8 in 2023, 46th of 54.

Legislation and regulation

Somalia's identity statute gives citizens a right to an identity credential rather than a duty to hold one: Law No. 009 of 2023 imposes no obligation to obtain an ID and criminalises only fraud and obstruction, which is the ground on which a published legal reading of the September 2025 presidential proclamation ordering universal use argues that it turned a right into an obligation without legislative debate. The chain behind it runs from Law No. 41 of December 2020, which created DADSOM, to the Identification and Registration Act of March 2023 that established the National Identification and Registration Authority, with the identification and data-protection laws both taking effect in 2023.

Telecommunications rests on the National Communications Law of 2017, which carries the statutory framework for broadband, spectrum management including TV white spaces, and universal access. Beyond it the book thins. As at December 2025 the Cybercrimes Bill had completed its first reading in the House of the People and been referred to committee for a second, without substantive debate; Parliament approved the Cybersecurity Law on 26 January 2026. A technical working group opened in June 2026 to develop a submarine-cable regulatory framework, alongside outage management and competition rules.

Personal data is the one field with a settled regime, a cross-sector Data Protection Act having been in force since March 2023. Compliance with what is already on the books is a separate matter: the 2025 audit recorded 66 legal-compliance breaches by government bodies, including US$18.5m of contracts awarded without following committee procedures. A six-chapter cybersecurity bill had its first reading in the Upper House on 29 August 2026, short of the second and third readings final approval requires. A draft Penal Code to replace the 1962 code with provisions for offences involving digital platforms and information systems was before Parliament in October 2026, with no timetable for a final vote.

Data protection

In June 2026 Somalia's Data Protection Authority issued a notice under Article 32 of the Data Protection Act requiring all data controllers and processors to complete mandatory registration, and began accepting applications and issuing compliance certificates — the regulator's first nationwide compliance step.

The statute behind it, Law No. 005 of 2023, has been in force since 23 March 2023 and is grounded in Article 19 of the 2012 Provisional Constitution. It is a general cross-sector instrument, setting out lawful bases for processing, data-subject rights, data-protection impact assessment and data-protection-officer duties, and a registration requirement for "controllers of major importance", alongside cross-border transfer restrictions and breach notification duties. Article 25 gives controllers 72 hours from becoming aware of a breach likely to risk rights and freedoms to notify the Authority, and requires notice to affected individuals where the risk is high, and breaches carry fines of 2 to 4 per cent of worldwide annual turnover.

The Authority was inaugurated on 24 February 2024 with power to issue regulations, investigate, impose fines and register controllers and processors of major importance, and has since issued implementation guidance and an alternative dispute resolution procedure. Its leadership is appointed by the executive. The Council of Ministers approved the regulatory framework operationalising the Act on 8 January 2026.

Somalia imposes no data localisation requirement on personal, government, financial or critical infrastructure data, applying instead an adequacy-based cross-border transfer regime under which controllers assess protection in the receiving jurisdiction or rely on contractual safeguards or consent. Redress runs through general channels: the constitutional right the Act rests on, the rights of access, rectification, deletion and objection it grants, and the alternative dispute resolution procedure issued under Article 41. In payments, conduct duties rest on the Central Bank's Mobile Money Regulations as amended in 2020, with no comprehensive payments consumer protection statute or formal redress framework.

Regional collaboration

Regional rules on cross-border data flows and personal data protection had been approved at East African Community level as at July 2026 and must still clear the Community's decision-making organs before any partner state, Somalia among them, adopts them; no adoption date has been published. Somalia is inside that process as a full EAC member since March 2024, one of the bloc's eight partner states. The continental tier is being joined on a schedule of its own: the AfCFTA Secretariat closed a visit to Mogadishu in August 2026 having agreed that Somalia will become the 50th state party on depositing its instrument of ratification in September 2026, on a sequence

running from ratification through domesticating the electronic tariff book and configuring preferential tariffs in the customs administration to completing outstanding EAC tariff and services commitments and a first shipment, with the continental payment system and the AfCFTA Adjustment Fund named as the instruments available and the national chamber of commerce asking for access to services markets including telecommunications, logistics, finance and digital commerce.

The monetary track is slower. The 29th Ordinary Meeting of the EAC Monetary Affairs Committee held the single-currency target at 2031 while recording that no partner state has attained all four primary macroeconomic convergence criteria (July 2026), and the central bank's membership of the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System is signed but not yet live. Somalia signed ratification of the African Continental Free Trade Area in early August 2026, the commitment its trade-facilitation systems are being built to serve, and it belongs to COMESA, CEN-SAD and IGAD, scoring 38.5 out of 100 on regional integration in 2023, 35th of 54 and up 7.6 points over the decade.

The harder border is the internal one. Puntland and Jubbaland have declined to implement the federal national ID, and Puntland has created its own identification authority, accusing Mogadishu of overreach on data control, election influence and regional autonomy (September 2025). A 15-member delegation's ten-day mission to Pakistan on digital identity closed in September 2026 with three working groups and an action matrix, and a delegation studied Tanzania's labour and employment digital systems in August 2026.

Standards

The risk named in Somali analysis is not a failure to digitise but digitising the existing fragmentation, with weak coordination treated as a governance problem calling for role clarity, interoperability standards and accountability rather than more procurement (April 2026). The gap it points at is real: there is no whole-of-government data exchange platform and no shared government enterprise architecture or interoperability layer, and NIRA's own Director General acknowledged in June 2025 that siloed databases and the absence of interoperability standards remain a major obstacle.

Payments are where published standards have actually been adopted, with the instant payment system built on the ISO 20022 messaging standard, a national standardised QR code layered on it, and Hormuud's EVC Plus holding GSMA Mobile Money certification.

In trade, the official charged with delivery has set the premise that clear mandates and compatible procedures must accompany the digital systems, since automating confusion would move the same problems online (August 2026). The auditor general's office completed the third phase of a cooperation programme on auditing government information systems in August 2026, and the national bureau of standards is the country's member body of the international standards organisation (2026).

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Media freedom is among Somalia's ten most deteriorated governance indicators, having fallen 6.7 points over 2014-2023 to 38.9 out of 100, 44th of 54 African states. Freedom of expression and belief scores 19.3 out of 100 in 2023, 49th of 54, down 0.3 points across the decade, and digital freedom scores 39.7, 39th of 54, equally flat over the same period — the online space has neither followed the offline decline nor pulled away from it.

Consultation happens where a document needs validating rather than where a decision needs testing. The Digital Transformation Strategy went to a national multi-stakeholder workshop in October 2025, and the National Communications Authority convened a national consultation in April 2026 to develop a cybersecurity risk-management and compliance framework. Licensing has moved faster than either: Starlink's entry was fast-tracked

and its full foreign-ownership model accommodated without major public debate (August 2025). The information ministry said on 3 September 2026 that the federal government had closed 82,000 social media pages during the year that it alleges carried armed-group propaganda. Amnesty International reported in May 2026 that journalists in Somalia were attacked by security forces and subjected to threats, harassment, arbitrary arrests and prosecution, as the government stepped up attempts to control reporting on insecurity, corruption and forced evictions.

Finance

Financial sustainability

Somalia's central bank now pays for the national payment switch out of its own budget: its 2024 accounts put the rise in system-licence costs to US$1.26m down to the Switch Payment System licence, previously paid by the World Bank and now paid by the bank.

The treasury's operating budget carries 15.4% of the digital lines of the 2026 appropriation, US$6.2m of US$40.6m, against 10.4% in 2025; external project grants carry the rest.

The share moved because the grants shrank: the 2026 appropriation carries US$8.0m for the World Bank's SCALED-UP grant and US$13.6m for the regional digital integration project EA-RDIP, against US$36.3m and US$11.8m in 2025. What the treasury carries is running costs: US$2.07m for the national identification authority, US$1.32m for the communications ministry's administration, US$0.68m for the communications regulator, US$0.24m for the Data Protection Authority and US$0.18m for government digitalisation in 2026.

Domestic lines are spent; donor lines lag. In 2025 the identification authority spent US$1.29m of its US$2.03m and the communications ministry 97% of its line, while EA-RDIP disbursed US$3.12m of its US$11.79m and the Data Protection Authority's US$1.83m project budget nothing. US$10m of EA-RDIP's financing for Somalia was cancelled in April 2026.

MoUs and other agreements

The European framework Somalia signed for digital government and cybersecurity closed in 2025: the D4D Initiative for Digital Government and Cybersecurity for the Horn of Africa, a EUR 3 million technical assistance programme co-financed by the European Union and Germany's BMZ, ran from 2022 and covered Somalia alongside Kenya and Djibouti, with GIZ leading on e-government, Expertise France on cybersecurity and FIIAPP on change management. What has been signed since is cooperation rather than money: Somalia's cybersecurity build-out rests on partnerships with Turkey, Malaysia and the UN Office on Drugs and Crime (March 2026).

New investments

No other institution comes close to the World Bank: five of the thirteen digital-sector commitments on record are its own, and about USD 328 million of the roughly USD 354 million committed, around 88 per cent of the Somalia-only total once regional programmes are set aside (August 2026). The thirteen were announced between 2015 and August 2026 and run to 2028, with about USD 189 million for Somalia alone and the rest in three regional programmes. All of it is public money — four concessional loans, every one the World Bank's, six grants and three technical assistance operations, with no equity, commercial lending or guarantees. European financiers hold six of the thirteen but only about USD 20 million of the value (August 2026). Statistical capacity is the largest destination by number, taking four, ahead of government systems with three.

The SCALED-UP credit of USD 31 million, approved in March 2019, and its USD 70 million additional financing of June 2021 run to 2026 across digital skills, financial services and job creation, and digital ID is a major pillar of the World Bank's SPRING initiative, a programme of over USD 100 million (December 2025). Somalia is one of two

sovereign borrowers, with South Sudan, under the USD 162 million Eastern Africa Regional Digital Integration Project approved in May 2023. Two earlier Bank operations closed in 2023: a USD 50 million public financial management project that rolled IFMIS out across the federal government, Puntland and Somaliland, and a USD 15 million trust-funded grant that built the telecom policy and regulatory environment.

Everyone else works at a tenth of that scale. The European Union committed in 2024 EUR 4.5 million (about USD 5 million) of IT equipment to security and justice institutions to 2028; Sweden funds SEK 45 million (about USD 5 million) for the DHIS2 national health information system to 2026 and has approved SEK 20.5 million for the IMF's Somalia Country Fund for 2023-2027; the UK GBP 3,312,013 (about USD 5 million) for statistical capacity to 2026; and the African Development Bank XDR 3.0 million (about USD 4 million) of statistics work to 2026.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Somalia's mobile network is one of its few genuinely improving national systems and its internet is not: Mobile Communications is the country's tenth best-scoring indicator on the Ibrahim Index at 45.0 out of 100 in 2023, up 20.8 points over the decade and among its ten most improved measures, while the same scorecard puts Internet & Computers at 21.9 out of 100, 43rd of 54, on a decade gain of just 6.1 points. The broader Infrastructure sub-category scores 21.5 out of 100, 49th of 54 and below the African average, having moved 6.4 points in ten years.

About 27.9 per cent of the population used the internet in 2024 on ITU data, and unique mobile subscriber penetration sits below 40 per cent, well under the raw subscription count that multi-SIM ownership inflates. The gap is no longer mainly one of network reach. Hormuud, the dominant operator, said in June 2026 that 4G covers more than 70 per cent of the population while nearly half its own device base still uses feature phones, which makes the handset, not the mast, the thing standing between a Somali and the internet.

Satellite has filled part of the rural gap since Starlink was licensed in April 2025, and AstaanConnect became the first official Somali reseller in September 2025, selling and installing locally on plans from $36.90 a month. Fixed capacity lands at Mogadishu, Berbera and Bosaso, but outside the cities last-mile electricity supply constrains what any of it can serve. Traffic exchange inside the country runs through an exchange point in Mogadishu, established on 20 November 2018 and listed as active (October 2026).

Two pieces of technical governance moved in 2026. The National Communications Authority is accelerating national migration to IPv6 under a strategy adopted in February 2025, ahead of IPv4 exhaustion, and in June 2026 it opened, with the IFC, Somalia's first Submarine Cable Landing Technical Working Group, meeting in Nairobi under the IFC Broadband Infrastructure Project. Voice calls interconnect across six licensed operators under a 2023 agreement, while mobile-money wallets remain closed to one another (October 2026), and Berbera is being positioned as an alternative regional gateway (September 2026), with capacity and landing arrangements not held.

Data Storage

The Somali government says its own data sits abroad. The Ministry of Communications and Technology stated in April 2024 that the National Data Center then being built in Mogadishu would "eliminate dependencies of national data on international data storage solutions, that is stored outside the country", and repeated the rationale in May 2025. That is the clearest official statement of where the country's public records physically are, and it is an admission rather than a plan.

The facility meant to change it has been a long time arriving. It is intended as the central repository for the data of all government institutions, and the minister described construction as nearing completion after a site visit on 6 May 2025, urging the implementing company toward timely and high-quality delivery. Fifteen months later, on 7 August 2026, the State Minister for Communications described the centre as planned rather than built.

Onshoring is therefore a stated aim with nothing behind it in law: Somalia imposes no data localisation requirement and instead runs an adequacy-based cross-border transfer regime under the Data Protection Act. Nor is there a domestic hyperscale option — no hyperscale provider operates a region in Somalia, the nearest availability zones being in Bahrain, the UAE and Qatar. The one independently tier-certified facility serving the country is Wingu Africa's carrier- and cloud-neutral Tier III data centre at Berbera in Somaliland, commissioned in 2021, outside federal jurisdiction.

Where onshore capacity has appeared, it has come from suppliers and operators rather than from the state's own build. Pakistan's NADRA delivered data centre infrastructure, ID card personalisation machines and secure ID cards for the national identification system in March 2025, and NIRA holds enrollees' fingerprints and facial images in a centralised, secure government database. Hormuud says it is investing in local data centres and in solar-powered network sites. Its chairman put the estate at 11 data centres with 10 megawatts of combined capacity, some drawing up to 95 per cent of daytime energy from solar (November 2025). A national infrastructure provider advertises off-site backup in Mombasa and Mogadishu with real-time replication (August 2026), and colocation in its own data centres in Mogadishu and Nairobi on a 10 Gbps backbone (October 2026).

Energy

Power in Somalia is not scarce so much as unaffordable: electricity averaged about USD 0.61 per kWh in 2023 and exceeded USD 1 per kWh where supply came from private diesel micro-grids, against roughly USD 0.15 in Kenya and USD 0.06 in Ethiopia. That is among the highest tariffs on the continent, and it is the number that decides whether a data centre, a tower site or a clinic terminal can be run at all.

Around 50.3 per cent of the population had access to electricity in 2023, and the National Bureau of Statistics published the country's first official SDG 7 energy indicators report in January 2026, drawing on the energy ministry, the national electricity authority and World Bank data. On the Ibrahim Index, Access to Energy scores 26.0 out of 100 for 2023, 37th of 54, and has moved 0.5 points in a decade — one of Somalia's better placings, and one of its flattest trends.

Supply is still overwhelmingly diesel, with solar and other renewables a minority of generation in 2023. The policy response is off-grid: the Ministry of Energy and Water Resources is developing a National Mini-grid Policy and Regulation with UNDP and GEF support through the Africa Mini-grids Programme, while deployment proceeds through projects including an AfDB-backed solar and grid programme in Bosaso. Reliability is barely measured: the nearest instrument is the World Bank's Somalia Enterprise Survey, fielded between June and November 2025, which puts infrastructure and services among the topics it asks firms about.

What that costs a digital service shows up at the point of care. In Mogadishu's Electronic Immunization Register, power cuts and unreliable connectivity mean staff still record on paper and upload later, so the system is not continuously online where it is used (February 2026).

Technical Capacity

The largest single improvement Somalia has recorded anywhere on the Ibrahim Index is in running a state: Public Administration — civil registration, statistical capacity, effective administration, tax and revenue mobilisation and budgetary management — gained 20.1 points over 2014-2023, the largest gain of any of the sixteen sub-categories, to reach 30.1 out of 100. It is still 48th of 54, as is Effective Administration on 30.7 out of 100 for 2023, itself up 15.9 points. The direction is real; the starting point was close to nothing.

In-house build has begun to appear alongside the procurement. NIRA's Director-General says HUBIYE, the Certificate Delivery System and the eAqoonsi mobile ID were "entirely developed by Somali engineers at NIRA" — a claim about the application layer, sitting above an identity system whose core technology and hardware come from Pakistan's NADRA, the primary technology partner. That is the shape of Somali technical capacity in 2026: Somali teams on the services citizens touch, foreign vendors underneath.

Two domestic technical institutions now anchor specific programmes. A National IPv6 Center hosted at Jamhuriya University supports the national IPv6 migration (June 2026), giving that work a base inside the country rather than in a consultancy. The national incident-response capability has a base of its own in SOMCIRT, opened in March 2026 to coordinate prevention, detection and response across institutions.

Outside government, the developer base is thin and self-organised, clustered around communities such as Dugsiiye and Somalis in Tech.

Cybersecurity

Somalia's national CERT is in place and its cyber law is not yet final. Parliament approved the Cybersecurity Law on 26 January 2026, giving policy responsibility to the Ministry of Communications and Technology, technical oversight to the National Communications Authority and compliance obligations to critical-infrastructure operators. The bill then went to the Upper House, where it had its first reading on 29 August 2026. The Somalia Computer Incident Response Team, mandated by that law, became operational on 7 March 2026, opened by Prime Minister Hamza Abdi Barre to coordinate prevention, detection and response and to issue national alerts. Before it, the country had scored 37.39 out of 100 in the ITU Global Cybersecurity Index 2024, placing it in Tier 4 of five.

The institutions are in place ahead of the rules they are meant to enforce. Somalia has no adopted cybersecurity risk-management and compliance framework: the National Communications Authority convened a national consultation in April 2026 to build one, covering risk identification, regulatory compliance and institutional responsibilities. The Cybercrimes Bill remained before Parliament, having completed its first reading in December 2025 and been referred to committee for a second, so prosecution of an incident SOMCIRT detects still rests on thinner ground than the defence of it. Breach reporting is the one obligation already in force, under the Data Protection Act's 72-hour notification duty. The statistics bureau found no records or reports on cybercrime at national level when compiling its 2024 governance statistics, and a draft Penal Code with provisions for digital offences was before Parliament in October 2026.

Capability is being bought in from abroad rather than grown. The build-out rests on a cooperation memorandum signed with Turkey on 10 February 2026 and closer ties with Malaysia and the UN Office on Drugs and Crime, following the EU- and German-financed D4D Initiative for Digital Government and Cybersecurity for the Horn of Africa, a EUR 3 million technical assistance programme covering Somalia alongside Kenya and Djibouti that ran to 2025. Assurance work on the state's most sensitive system has been commissioned without reaching the public: the Ministry of Finance tendered for a firm to assess security at NIRA headquarters and registration centres, and no results are in the public domain.

DPI

Data Exchange

Somalia's Auditor-General found in the 2025 annual audit that seven government revenue and financial-management systems — business registration, e-tax, road tax, rental income tax, e-visa, non-tax e-revenue and digital financial services collection — are not integrated with the Somali Financial Management Information System, and a separate IT audit of the customs system published in January 2025 found no integration between customs and the government's other revenue-collection systems. Behind the individual findings sits a structural one: Somalia has no whole-of-government data exchange platform and no primary legislation establishing authority for cross-government data sharing, so ministries and agencies hold data in their own separate systems with no shared enterprise architecture between them.

What does cross moves point to point rather than through a shared layer. The instant payment system is built on the ISO 20022 messaging standard, the one national standard in production use, but integration of the mobile money providers into it remains outstanding, with no published date, leaving the country's dominant payment rails outside the national instant payment system (July 2026).

Most of the joins that would matter are pipeline rather than plumbing. Integration of the digital civil registration system with the national ID, healthcare, immigration and education systems is under development with UNICEF and German government support and has not been completed (2025), and linking the Unified Social Registry to the identity system is described in government and humanitarian coordination documents as a future goal (October 2025). NIRA's Director General acknowledged in June 2025 that the siloed nature of Somali government databases and the absence of interoperability standards remain a major obstacle.

Coordination has so far been convened rather than built. Somalia held its first National Digital Public Infrastructure Summit in Mogadishu on 14-15 February 2026, bringing the Central Bank, the National Communications Authority, NIRA and the Data Protection Authority together to map interoperability across the digital estate, and NIRA opened a National ID and Public Service Integration Working Group with UNDP in June 2026. The Digital Transformation Strategy for 2025-2030 is meant to coordinate all of it, and there is no standalone data exchange strategy. The accountant general's office moved in August 2026 to link the government payroll system with the national identity database, with a pilot across five government institutions from 1 October 2026 and full implementation targeted for 31 December 2027.

Digital Identity and CRVS

The identity authority counted more than 1.4 million people registered for the national ID in March 2026, and the interior minister more than 1.5 million in September 2026, but the eAqoonsi mobile ID app had recorded only about 50,000 downloads and digital activation still requires an in-person visit to a NIRA centre first. The programme is targeting 15 million issuances by the end of 2029, and passed one million enrolments by November 2025, while NIRA's director general put about 85 per cent of citizens as holding no legal identity (June 2025).

The system rests on the National Identification and Registration Act of March 2023, which created NIRA and set its mandate, eligibility rules and biometric requirements; Pakistan's NADRA supplies the core identity management system and hardware. The credential is verified through the consent-based, OTP-driven HUBIYE platform, to which more than 24 services had been integrated by November 2025.

Somalia has made the ID compulsory faster than it has enrolled people. Enrolment is mandatory for all citizens, and an April 2025 prime ministerial directive requires government and private-sector institutions to integrate the ID into service delivery; it has since been required for bank accounts under a Central Bank measure that took effect on

1 September 2025, for driver's licences and vehicle registration, and from March 2026 for travel between federal states. In September 2025 President Hassan Sheikh Mohamud ordered every agency and business to use the ID and called it "a national crime" to serve anyone who does not hold one — in a federation where two member states have declined to implement the federal ID at all. The travel requirement was enforced from 1 October 2026, when passengers at Garowe in Puntland, where the identification authority keeps no registration offices, were refused boarding.

Civil registration is the weaker half. Around 3.5 per cent of children under five were registered and 0.3 per cent held a birth certificate (2020), and Somalia's civil registration score on the Ibrahim Index for 2023 was 53rd of 54 African states. A Unified Digital Civil Registration Service was piloted in 19 districts on 10 August 2025, registering births, deaths, marriages and divorces into a centralised national database, and had reached around 30 districts and 160 linked hospitals, with more than 28,000 births registered at the point of occurrence (January 2026). The identity application had passed 50,000 downloads by August 2026, and the identity authority's services are to be linked to the unified public service delivery centre, planned and not implemented at 6 October 2026. Two requirements are announced and not made: access to SIM cards is to depend on the national identity credential, and the deputy prime minister asked in September 2026 for social media accounts to require the national identity number. Cabinet approved a third-generation e-passport plan on 6 August 2026, with no issuance date, and the immigration agency presented its biometric passport, electronic visa and travel-data exchange to the African Union's counterterrorism centre in September 2026.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Somalia's national instant payment system has been live since January 2025, but the rails that carry most of the country's money are still outside it: integration of the mobile money providers into SIPS remains outstanding, with no published date (July 2026). Mobile money is worth roughly $8bn a year, about 36 per cent of GDP, across some 650 million transactions annually, built almost entirely by private operators Hormuud and Telesom in the absence of state provision (January 2026), and 81.8% of Somalis use it (2024).

SIPS launched in January 2025 as the first nationwide instant payment system, carrying instant transfers from mobile and banking apps and QR payments under a national standard, SOMQR. It is operated by the Somalia Payment Switch, a joint venture between the Central Bank of Somalia and 13 commercial banks, and it already carries person-to-person, merchant, government-to-person and person-to-government payments, with business-facing services still in development (July 2026). The Central Bank signed the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System membership agreement in March 2026 and is undertaking technical onboarding, with Somalia listed as "live soon" rather than live (June 2026).

Government payment out has almost finished going digital while government collection has not. The non-formalised, non-security wage bill fell from 36.3 per cent in 2021 to 0.03 per cent by the end of 2025, so salaries — the dominant government-to-person flow — now move almost entirely through digital channels, against a 2022 Public Financial Management Regulation requiring all public-sector payroll to be paid by electronic funds transfer. Sales tax is deducted at 5 per cent from businesses using mobile-money merchant accounts through the Electronic Tax Administration System, alongside digitised rental-income tax collection, but customs duties cleared under the Somali Customs Automated System still require a manual bank receipt and cashier step (2024).

On the private side, Hormuud's EVC Plus holds GSMA Mobile Money re-certification, one of only about ten platforms worldwide to meet the standard alongside M-PESA and MTN MoMo (August 2025). Consumer protection rests on the Central Bank's Mobile Money Regulations as amended in 2020, with no comprehensive payments statute behind them.

Registries

Biometric voter registration is the register that moved: the National Independent Electoral and Boundaries Commission registered roughly 919,000 to one million voters in Mogadishu and Banadir between April and September 2025 ahead of November 2025 council elections, and about 216,000 in Galmudug ahead of a vote set for 20 July 2026, with Puntland and Jubaland outside the process. It runs on the commission's own biometric fingerprint capture, with the digital infrastructure built by contractor NOVA GROUP and registrants presenting a passport, national ID card or birth certificate as prior proof of identity (2025).

The business register is the oldest of the functional registers and the most used. The Ministry of Commerce and Industry has run an online business registration and licensing portal since March 2022, built with IFC and World Bank support and extended to Jubaland in 2024, which has substantially cut registration and licensing times — against a formal business base the National Bureau of Statistics counted in its 2024/25 establishment census.

The Unified Social Registry is operational and used to target beneficiaries of the Baxnaano cash-transfer programme, combining a proxy means test with district distress ratings — a composite of food insecurity, malnutrition and rural concentration — for geographic targeting (September 2025), and linking it to the national identification system is planned but not yet operational (October 2025). The Somalia Revenue Directorate operates a digital tax administration covering both individual income taxpayers and corporate taxpayers, alongside the Somali Customs Automated System (2025).

Land is the register that does not exist. Somalia has no unified national digital land or title register: administration is split across customary Xeer, Sharia and secular traditions, land records have been lost and destroyed, and what exists is municipal — Garowe and Bosaso register ownership and transfers locally, and UN-Habitat has built GIS databases for tax collection in Hargeisa, Boroma, Berbera, Garowe and Gardo, the largest of them carrying no ownership information (December 2024). The migration agency, the federal government and the Netherlands launched a programme that will support civil registration and legal identity systems and expand registration in underserved areas (2026). Addressing has been announced and piloted but not built: the communications minister announced the Somali Postal Service with a digital addressing system in June 2024, and a diaspora startup has piloted verifiable digital addresses in several cities under memoranda with four states and regions (December 2024). The country's first unified national registry of health facilities was launched in Mogadishu on 23 August 2026, and Somaliland's central bank agreed with banks and mobile-money operators in September 2026 that it will lead a credit information bureau.

Sectoral management information systems

The Somalia Revenue Directorate is still developing and procuring a fuller Integrated Tax Administration System (2025), leaving the existing Financial Management Information System providing only basic revenue receipting and taxpayer number generation for inland revenue collections. Where systems exist they stand apart from one another, as the Auditor-General's IT audit of the customs system in January 2025 found.

Health is the deepest deployment and still a thin one. The national platform is DHIS2, which UNICEF and the University of Oslo's HISP Centre agreed in August 2025 to strengthen under a further three-year agreement. An Electronic Immunization Register built on it assigns each vaccinated child a unique identifier, and has been piloted in 14 health facilities in Banadir region and is being scaled to more than 80 facilities nationwide (February 2026); the CaafimaadPlus digitalised data system had by 2026 expanded from a five-facility pilot to more than 40 facilities across nine regions and 25 districts, pushing frontline clinical data into the federal DHIS2 platform in real time. Underneath the pilots the process is manual: most health facilities record patient data on twelve standard paper registries, aggregated into monthly summary forms that district health information officers key into DHIS2 rather than entering it at the point of service (2022).

Education is further back: the national Education Management Information System collects school data once a year, and headteachers still sort and file the underlying school records by hand (2024). Justice gained a system in 2025: an Integrated Electronic Case Management System launched on 9 October 2025 with US funding and IDLO support, linking the Criminal Investigation Department, the Attorney General's Office, the Supreme Court, Benadir regional and appeal courts and Mogadishu Central Prison on one digital platform, with deployment phased rather than nationwide.

Public financial management is where the measured improvement sits: on the Ibrahim Index, Tax and Revenue Mobilisation rose 22.2 points over 2014-2023 to 34.7 out of 100, 40th of 54, and Budgetary and Financial Management 20.8 points to 37.5, 46th of 54. The health ministry's quarterly bulletin counted 579 public health facilities reporting to DHIS2 in July to September 2023, against 532 a year earlier. The planning ministry launched a system on 8 September 2026 for monitoring plan implementation across all 26 federal ministries, and a Pandemic Fund project on health emergency preparedness was launched in Mogadishu on 20 August 2026.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Somalia scored 0.1468 on the UN E-Government Development Index for 2024, ranking 191st of 193 member states and placing it in the index's low group. What a citizen can transact online is correspondingly thin, and most of what exists is identity verification attached to an in-person service rather than a service delivered online: since June 2025 the Ministry of Transport and Aviation has required a NIRA-issued national ID card to obtain a driver's licence, register a vehicle or use any other service it offers, taking effect immediately and consistent with the April 2025 prime ministerial order.

The clearest new citizen-facing service is the Somali National Job Portal for Employment Opportunities, a centralised, domestically hosted platform through which public-sector vacancies are advertised and applied for (February 2026).

Paying the state is ahead of filing with it. The Revenue Directorate offers downloadable personal income, corporate income and withholding tax return forms for manual submission, with no electronic filing linked to the QR payment channel that already accepts tax and fee payments, while at state level Hirshabelle has replaced a manual revenue voucher reconciliation cycle of 30 to 45 days with automatic reconciliation in its digitised tax collection system (July 2026).

The plan for domestic hosting and digital service delivery is set out in the ministry's eGovernment Strategy for 2025-2029, and the National Data Centre meant to carry it was not yet operational at the responsible minister's site visit in May 2025, and was described as planned rather than built in August 2026. On trade, no timetable, budget or vendor has been stated for any of Somalia's named trade-facilitation digital systems, including the planned National Single Window (August 2026). The federal government was negotiating in August 2026 to exempt one region's residents from the electronic visa fee while keeping the entry system in place.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

The most developed digital system run by a tier of government below the national one is a revenue platform in Hirshabelle. SUMER, built by the Mogadishu firm Tabaarak ICT, collects border checkpoint revenue through a card terminal that holds the tariff schedule on the device: the officer enters vehicle type, origin and category, the terminal returns the amount due, payment moves over mobile money straight into the government account with no merchant intermediary, and a QR-coded receipt posts to a central system in real time (July 2026). Holding the tariff on the terminal is the point of it: the amount is not the officer's to set.

What it replaced was physical. Paper vouchers were carried up to 90km and keyed in by hand, a reconciliation the state's finance minister puts at 30 to 45 days and which remained incomplete, and shilling cash sat 48 hours in the treasury for conversion to dollars before deposit (July 2026). The state reports a many-fold rise in collections at equipped checkpoints in the first quarter of 2026 against 2020.

Beyond that, sub-national involvement is participation in national systems rather than systems of the states' own. Local administrations in Jubbaland, South West, Hirshabelle, Galmudug and Northeastern State take part in the digital civil registration pilot in 19 districts, which the interior ministry announced on Africa CRVS Day in August 2025. Land is the clearest case of the gap: with no unified national digital land or title register, municipal land registration runs in isolation in Garowe and Bosaso, alongside UN-Habitat GIS databases built for tax collection in Hargeisa, Boroma, Berbera, Garowe and Gardo (2024), each a town's own arrangement rather than a tier of the state.

In Baidoa a UN-Habitat drive mapped and registered 21,400 properties on a GIS and named and signed the roads (March 2021). A UN agency reported in August 2021 that Garowe's local revenue had tripled on mobile tax and the financial system, and that the scheme was extended to four more districts. A 2023 governance brief found only Puntland councils running such a system. The UN programme's final report counts about 22,000 Garowe properties geo-referenced and paid by mobile money.

Rural digital data capture

Where the Somali state itself does the recording outside the capital, it records on paper: rural police stations keep occurrence books, station diaries, crime registers and property registers in hard copy (2025), and the Somali Police Force's Basic Recruit Curriculum trains officers in police books and forms with no digital tool anywhere in it. Health follows the same pattern. Most health facilities write patient data onto twelve standard paper registries covering hospital inpatients, over-five and under-five outpatients and immunisation, which district health information officers then key into the national DHIS2 system monthly rather than capturing it digitally at the point of service (2022). In education school records are still sorted and filed by hand, though headteachers in schools supported by a Global Partnership for Education programme have been trained to capture and upload student data into the national Education Management Information System directly (2024).

Digital capture that does reach rural areas arrives through programmes rather than through the line ministries. A donor-run health programme now runs in more than 40 facilities across nine regions, pushing frontline clinical data into the federal DHIS2 platform in real time and capturing medicine dispensing on handheld devices (2026), and the Unified Digital Civil Registration Service put district registration offices in five federal member states online for births, deaths, marriages and divorces in August 2025. Agriculture has no comparable system in the field; e-agriculture has been a stated goal of the National ICT Policy and Strategy since 2019. The constraint underneath all of it is power: about half the population had access to electricity in 2023, at some of the highest tariffs in Africa.

The wider rural picture has been deteriorating on the Ibrahim Index of African Governance: Rural Land and Water Access is Somalia's most deteriorated indicator, scoring zero out of 100 in 2023 and ranking 45th of 54, while Rural Economy Support stood at 26.5 and 43rd and Rural Representation and Participation at 24.5 and 42nd, unchanged across the decade to 2023. Rural Economy is one of only two sub-categories moving against the country's overall improvement.

Technology

AI

Somalia's artificial intelligence effort sits outside government: the National AI Center, established in October 2024, moved from the communications ministry to the Somali National University in July 2026 and works on research, education and industry capacity-building rather than on putting AI into state systems. At regional level the East African Community is developing an AI policy roadmap intended to cover all eight partner states, Somalia among them, on the argument that East Africa should govern artificial intelligence as a single bloc rather than country by country; it was still under discussion as at March 2026. Somalia is one of the eight partner states covered by the same bloc's German-funded regional AI research and training network, whose 2025 pilot mobilised 3,900 students across 100 universities in the region. A national artificial-intelligence readiness assessment is under way with UNESCO (August 2026), a predictive food-security platform released in April 2026 informed assistance to 48,000 people, and a Somali-built climate early-warning system is deployed with a state disaster-management ministry (September 2026).

Somali-language models are being built outside the state: a Mogadishu lab released a speech-recognition model trained on 320 hours of audio (May 2026), and a university AI institute is preparing datasets and prototype text and speech models for public services and content moderation (January 2026).

ICT Industry

Somalia's business and competition regulation scores 13.6 out of 100 (2023), 53rd of 54 African countries despite a ten-point rise over the decade, and the technology industry that has grown inside that environment is a wholly private one. Hormuud and Telesom built the country's mobile money system in the absence of state provision, and Hormuud's EVC Plus holds GSMA mobile money re-certification. New product development sits with the operators too: Hormuud's smartphone financing scheme underwrites customers on telecom credit scoring built from SIM tenure and mobile-money spending rather than formal credit history (May 2026). Outside the operators the domestic software developer community is small and emerging, organised around groups such as Dugsiiye and Somalis in Tech (2023).

Innovation ecosystem

Somalia is not among the 133 economies covered by the Global Innovation Index 2024, so the country carries no innovation rank or score at all. What exists on the ground is a small hub network — iRise Hub, HarHub, Ganacsikaab, Tilmaam i-HUB and SIMAD-iLab, concentrated in Mogadishu, Hargeisa and Garowe (2022). Commercial tracking records several hundred Somalia-linked startups, several dozen of which have raised outside funding, with fresh rounds closing in the first quarter of 2026. The public side runs through the World Bank's SCALED-UP project, which supports digital entrepreneurship, digital skills and ICT sector development to 2026.

Capacity

Literacy

Education is Somalia's worst-scoring governance sub-category, at 10.0 out of 100 for 2023 and last of the 54 African states measured, a place it holds despite an 8.9-point rise over the preceding decade. Enrolment scores 4.4, ranking 51st, and equality in education 8.8, ranking 53rd — both among the country's ten weakest indicators of any kind — while education quality has moved furthest, from zero to 16.7 over the same ten years (2023).

The systems built on top of that schooling are themselves mostly unread: schools keep their records on paper for headteachers to sort and file by hand, and the national education management information system collects school data once a year (2024).

Training and skills

Government ICT staff were put through internationally certified cybersecurity training in incident management and response, cloud data security and the auditing of security policies, run across Mogadishu and Nairobi between 28 March and 8 May 2026 by the National Communications Authority in partnership with the World Bank Group. Training of this kind arrives attached to particular infrastructure programmes rather than to a skills policy: the same pattern produced the national incident-response team (March 2026), the technical base for IPv6 migration hosted at Jamhuriya University (June 2026), and digital skills as one strand of the World Bank's SCALED-UP work alongside financial inclusion, entrepreneurship and ICT sector development.

Somalia is named among the eight member states of the East African Community's regional AI research and training network, funded by Germany's BMZ with EUR 5 million and intended to equip 50,000 young people with digital skills alongside an EAC artificial intelligence strategy for 2025-2028 (August 2026). Domestic university provision predates all of it: Mogadishu University has run a faculty of computer science and information technology since 2003, and computer science and IT was the largest field among 25,230 first-degree graduates from 69 universities in 2022, at 3,136.

Research institutions

Somalia gave knowledge production an institutional home in October 2024, when it established a National AI Center whose remit is research, education and industry capacity-building rather than putting artificial intelligence to work inside government systems. The centre moved from the communications ministry to the Somali National University in July 2026. What sits beside it is regional rather than national: Somalia is one of the eight member states covered by the East African Community's AI research and training network, funded by Germany's BMZ with EUR 5 million, whose 2025 pilot mobilised 3,900 students across 100 universities in the region alongside an EAC artificial intelligence strategy for 2025-2028 (August 2026).

Inclusion

Access to services

Somalia scores 14.2 out of 100 on equal access to public services and 20.1 on equal socioeconomic opportunity, 50th and 48th of 54 African countries, and the first of those has risen by under two points in a decade (2023). The obstacle is rarely that a service does not exist, but that obtaining it requires a document most people do not hold: the great majority of Somalis have no legal identity (June 2025), birth registration has been close to absent (2020), and even the mobile ID app requires an in-person visit to a NIRA centre before it can be activated (April 2026) — centres still being opened district by district in Mogadishu (April 2025).

For some groups the document barrier is written into the rules. Refugees and asylum seekers cannot open a formal bank account in Somalia, because neither the federal anti-money laundering framework nor Somaliland's 2019 AML/CFT Act recognises refugee identity documents as valid customer due diligence evidence; the 2015 Money Transfer Businesses customer registration regulations leave them tiered access to lower-threshold mobile money accounts, the only formal channel open to them (2022). Provision for disabled users is charitable rather than designed: a diaspora organisation distributes speaking mobile phones to blind people in Mogadishu to support mobile banking use (2025).

Where a service is reached at all, it is usually over privately built rails. Formal banking touches a small minority of Somalis while mobile money reaches most of them (2026), so government charges and humanitarian cash alike ride on operator infrastructure, and social assistance is paid into mobile wallets (2024). Cost sorts the rest. Mobile data is relatively inexpensive at around $0.50 per GB (2025), but the satellite service that covers the places the networks do not costs $390 for hardware and $70 a month, or $210 for the mini terminal (August 2025), and the electricity to run any of it is among the most expensive in Africa (2023). The consequences show up in basic services: most Somali children have received no routine vaccination (2026), the gap the electronic immunization register is being scaled to close.

Digital divides

On Somalia's largest network the coverage has run ahead of the handsets needed to use it: most of Hormuud's network carries 4G while a large part of its subscriber base is still on 2G or feature phones (May 2026), which makes the device, rather than network reach, what limits who gets online. The operator's answer is credit rather than coverage: with Get-Phone it is financing smartphones on a $19 deposit and $0.60 to $1.60 a day, repaid through EVC Plus and bundled with 1GB and 40 minutes, aiming at 100,000 handsets across central and southern Somalia by the end of 2026 with Puntland and Somaliland to follow.

The lines drawn by the digital ID rollout run along connectivity and literacy. Women, the elderly and people with disabilities are the groups most at risk of being left behind, which is why SMS and USSD channels have been urged as an alternative to a smartphone app whose downloads remain a small fraction of registrations (April 2026). Documents and insecurity cut across the same rollout: feeder documents such as birth certificates are widely missing, and insecurity in conflict-affected areas and the absence of roads and electricity are named alongside them as hurdles (June 2025).

The older divides have not moved with the technology. Internet use remains a minority of the population (2024), 30.8% of males and 24.7% of females aged 10 and over in 2022, and Somalia's score on the Ibrahim Index's internet and computers measure sits in the bottom quarter of the continent (2023). Electricity, without which none of it works, reached about half the population in 2023. Satellite service has been available across the whole country since August 2025, from Mogadishu and Hargeisa to pastoral Shabelle, so the remaining gap in those areas is one of price rather than reach. The statutory hook for closing it, universal access under the 2017 National Communications Law, has been in place throughout. More than 2,500 smartphones had been sold on credit since May 2026, against a target of 100,000 by the end of the year (September 2026).

Data

National statistics

Somalia's capacity to run a statistical system rose 29.1 points over the decade to 2023, reaching 35.1 out of 100 and 42nd of 54 African states, the fifth most improved of the 96 indicators the Ibrahim Index tracks for the country. That is movement from close to nothing rather than arrival at a working system. The World Bank records no population census, no agricultural census and no business census held within twenty years, as at 2023, and on the same measure no household survey, no health survey and no business survey in the ten years to 2023, alongside one labour survey and two agricultural surveys.

The gap is in collection rather than in what is made of the result. Somalia's weakest statistical performance pillar by a wide margin is data sources, scoring under 20%, while data products sit in the 50-69% band and data use in the 70-89% band (2023).

The National Bureau of Statistics has begun filling that gap with instruments of its own: its Business Establishment Census for 2024/25 identified roughly 48,000 formal business establishments. It launched a platform in August 2024 through which ministries report SDG indicator data to it, and compiled the first edition of a biennial Statistical Abstract from surveys and ministry administrative records in November 2024. It has also been building administrative data-sharing with line ministries, convening a second Joint Data and Statistics Forum in June 2025 with over 130 government and partner representatives, which produced clearer institutional roles and improved sharing mechanisms. Users are not yet feeling it: limited data-sharing platforms is one of the two most cited barriers reported in the bureau's 2025 user satisfaction survey.

What cannot be counted also shapes how Somalia appears elsewhere: the 2024 Ibrahim Index holds no data for the country on 19 of its 96 indicators, including every one of its public-perception measures, and vital statistics rest on a civil registration system that had registered 3.5 per cent of children under five as at 2020. The rebuilding is largely externally financed, with British and African Development Bank commitments to statistical capacity running to 2026.

Open data

Five of the 23 data categories the Open Data Inventory assessed for Somalia in 2024 score zero out of ten — among them banking, energy and crime statistics — meaning nothing at all was found published to the inventory's coverage and openness criteria. At the other end, government finance is the strongest category at 6.5 out of 10, followed by price statistics, the built environment, education facilities and gender statistics at 5.5 each, with nothing reaching 7.

Across the 23 categories assessed in 2024 the mean score is 3.7 out of 10, the whole distribution squeezed between a floor of zero and a ceiling of 6.5.

The direction is upward from a near-standing start. Somalia's disclosure of public records rose 19.1 points over 2014-2023 to 22.1 out of 100, 41st of 54, and accessibility of public records rose 13.2 points to 13.7, 44th of 54, leaving both in the bottom quarter of African states.

Where public information does reach the page it comes mostly through audit. The Auditor-General's 2025 annual audit covered 30 internationally financed projects — 22 funded by the World Bank, seven by the African Development Bank and one by the IMF — alongside a legal-compliance audit of 22 government bodies holding 60.1% of the national budget, which found 66 breaches of law and procurement procedure. The limits show in the same document: the audit could not independently verify the revenue share reported from the Mogadishu port and airport concession, because the underlying records were not available to it. The Central Bank is the steadier publisher, issuing audited financial statements prepared under IFRS and the Central Bank of Somalia Act 2012, with an independent audit opinion. A national consortium in the persistent-identifier network, led by the research and education network, lets universities mint identifiers for research outputs (September 2026).

Use of satellite data

No national programme for the state's use of earth-observation or geospatial data was in place as at August 2026: a partner-run remote-sensing service estimates cultivable area and production and maps land use (August 2026). One state body reads satellite data itself: the civil aviation authority installed a Meteosat Third Generation receiver in Mogadishu and a PUMA-2025 workstation, replacing a decade-old platform, to track lightning and convective storms (July 2025).

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

Somalia's border management runs on PISCES, the US-backed biometric screening system, which places the record of who crosses the country's frontiers on an American-supplied platform (March 2026). The same reach extends into policing: the FBI's Criminal Justice Information Services division issued a request for information in January 2025 seeking vendors to run Somalia's police automated biometric identification system at Aden Adde International Airport, Mogadishu's international gateway.

American money also sits under the justice system's case file. Somalia launched an Integrated Electronic Case Management System on 9 October 2025, funded by the US Bureau of International Narcotics and Law Enforcement Affairs and implemented with IDLO, linking the Criminal Investigation Department, the Attorney General's Office, the Supreme Court, the Benadir regional and appeal courts and Mogadishu Central Prison on a single digital platform; deployment is phased and does not yet run nationwide.

China activities

No Chinese-financed or Chinese-operated digital infrastructure was in place in Somalia as at August 2026.

EU activities

European public financiers are the most numerous funders of Somalia's digital sector and among the least consequential. Six of the thirteen commitments on record are European — the European Union, Germany's BMZ and GIZ, Sweden's Sida twice and the UK's FCDO — yet between them they account for only about USD 20 million of committed value, a fraction of the World Bank's (August 2026).

The European Union's own commitment, made in 2024, is EUR 4.5 million, about USD 5 million, to the ICT Support to the Security, Justice, Governance and Accountability Project, supplying IT and office equipment to Somali security and justice institutions at federal level and in two to three Federal Member States so that they can digitalise their human, financial and asset management. It runs to 2028.

European support has otherwise arrived regionally rather than nationally. Somalia was one of three countries covered by the D4D Initiative for Digital Government and Cybersecurity for the Horn of Africa, a EUR 3 million technical assistance programme co-financed by the European Union and Germany's BMZ that ran from 2022 to 2025, with GIZ leading e-government, Expertise France leading cybersecurity and FIIAPP leading change management; the same EUR 3 million covered Kenya and Djibouti alongside Somalia.

Gulf/UAE activities

No Gulf state or Gulf-owned operator held Somali digital infrastructure or a government platform contract as at August 2026.

India activities

India had no digital infrastructure, platform or vendor presence in Somalia as at August 2026.

Digital sovereignty

Somalia's customs system runs without the state holding its code: the Auditor-General's IT audit of SOMCAS found no escrow agreement for source-code ownership, posing significant legal and operational risks to the system's continuity, and no formal backup and recovery processes (January 2025).

The ministry's own diagnosis is that institutions save government data on their own servers for want of guidelines on shared and secure hosting, and its eGovernment Strategy 2025-2029 proposes a national data centre as cloud infrastructure for all government services, with disaster recovery for shared services, and rates dependence on technology vendors a high risk, to be met by in-house capacity and vendor-relationship management (August 2025). Guidelines on government data hosting and cloud adoption, a target of the World Bank's regional digital integration project, were still not in place in June 2026. A National Data Policy Framework validated in March 2026 is meant to ensure data is processed and managed in ways that protect national interests; no instrument fixing where state data is held or under whose law it is processed was in force as at October 2026.

The identity layer was built by another state: Pakistan's NADRA built the civil registration and vital statistics system and handed it over to the Somali authorities in November 2024, and a UNDP-convened mission in September 2026 validated a Somalia-Pakistan partnership action matrix on digital identity and digital public infrastructure. The terms on which the NADRA identity partnership and the US-supplied PISCES border system govern data jurisdiction, portability and exit had not been published as at September 2026.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-18**
COMPILED	By Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/SOM/SOM-status-2026-10-18.pdf
FEEDBACK	info@data-landscapers.io
LICENCE	CC BY 4.0